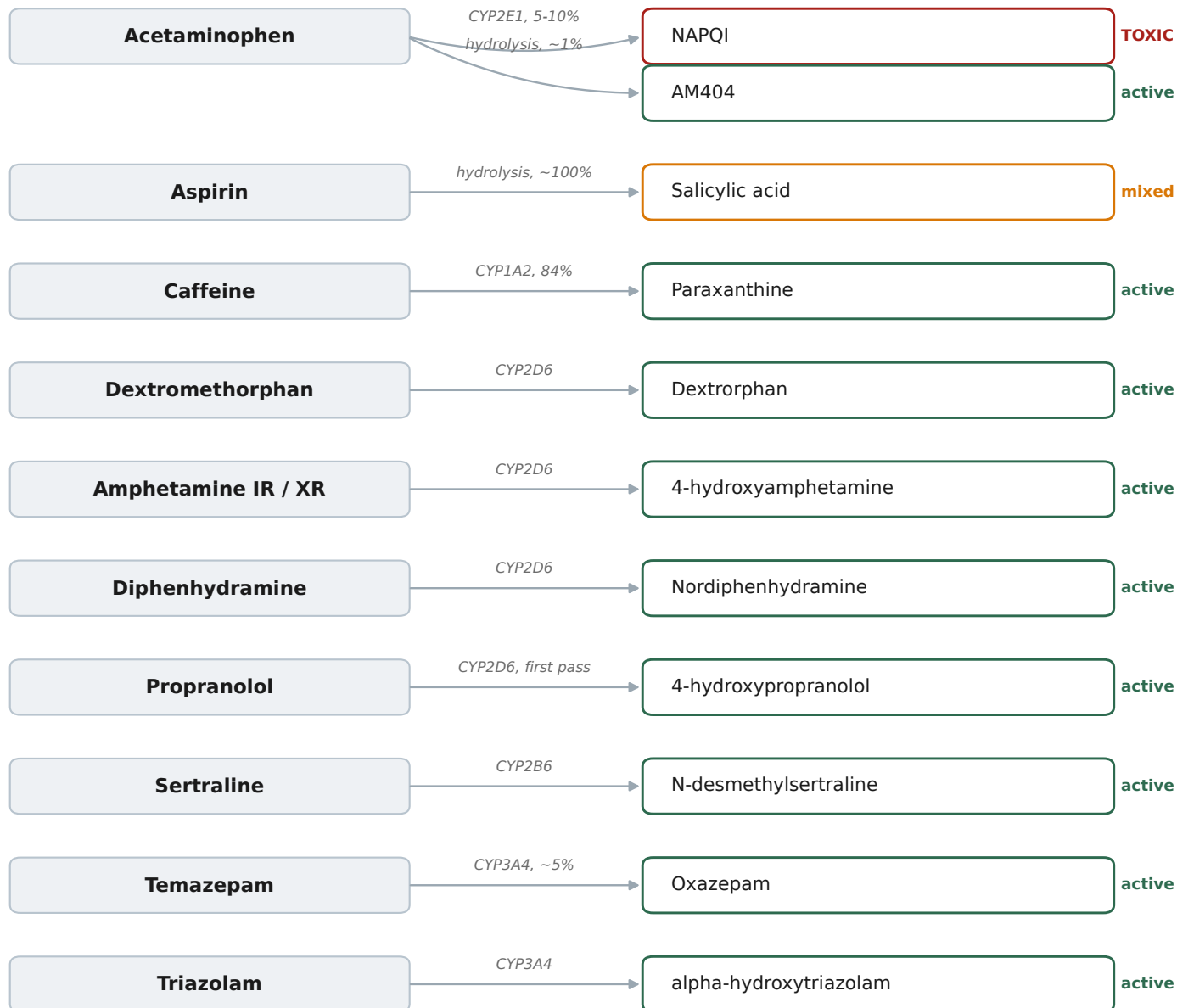


Active metabolites

Metabolites get their own record when something is true of them that is not true of the parent: their own mechanism, their own disposal route, their own half-life, or their own interactions.



WHY THESE HAVE THEIR OWN RECORDS

NAPQI

Its own mechanism (protein arylation) and its own antidote. Too reactive to have plasma PK at all — recorded as a settled absence, not a pending one.

Salicylic acid

Carries almost all of aspirin's systemic activity. Saturable elimination, so its half-life runs 2-3 h at low dose and 15-30 h at high dose.

Dextrorphan

A CYP2D6 inhibitor raises the parent and suppresses this at the same time. Effects redistribute between two different receptor profiles rather than adding up.

N-desmethylsertraline

Only 1/20 as potent, but a 62-104 h half-life against the parent's 26 h. It governs the washout, which is why sertraline interactions outlast the last dose.

Paraxanthine

84% of a caffeine dose passes through it at comparable potency. Much of what is experienced as caffeine is really this.